Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

Cheat Sheet: **Body Scan**

A way to get "out of your head" and anchor yourself in the body.

Body awareness leads to emotional awareness while also calming the mind.

Benefits

- Curbs rumination
- Improves awareness of your own emotional state
- Cultivates equanimity, the ability to experience discomfort without aversion and pleasure without grasping
- Promotes physical relaxation

Uses in Daily Life

- When your body feels tense (if you've been sitting for a while, consider pairing the body scan with some physical movement)
- When you feel mentally scattered, caught up in rumination, or "stuck in your head" (*e.g.*, losing the plot during a long research or writing session, feeling scattered after multiple calls or meetings)

Steps

- Move attention through the body, part by part. At each part, observe what sensations are present.
- You can choose the speed of your scan.
- If you experience a pleasant sensation, try not to feed a reaction of craving. If you experience an unpleasant sensation, try not to feed a reaction of aversion.
- If memories or emotions grab your attention, just note their presence, then return to observing the body.

Quick Version:

Adjust the speed of the practice by breaking up the body into fewer, larger groups (*e.g.*, feet and legs together, then entire torso, then arms and hands together, then head and neck together), or by spending less time with each group, or both.